Certificate in Pharmacy Curriculum

Allied Health Examinations Board — Teacher's Guide

Programme overview

The Certificate in Pharmacy is a two-year programme that prepares pharmacy assistants to dispense medicines safely in community and hospital pharmacies. Assessment: continuous assessment 40% and final examination 60%; pass mark 50%.

Course structure

Year	Semester	Code	Course unit	Contact hours
1	1	CP 111	Pharmaceutics I	45
1	1	CP 112	Pharmacology I	60
2	1	CP 211	Dispensing Practice	40

CP 111 Pharmaceutics I

Year 1, Semester 1. Contact hours: 45.
Course description: This unit introduces learners to pharmaceutics i.

Topic 1: Introduction to pharmaceutics (6 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Define pharmaceutics and dosage form; Classify dosage forms.

Topic 2: Solutions and suspensions (15 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Prepare oral solutions; Explain suspending agents.

Topic 3: Tablets and capsules (24 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Describe tablet manufacture; Compare tablets and capsules.

CP 112 Pharmacology I

Year 1, Semester 1. Contact hours: 60.
Course description: This unit introduces learners to pharmacology i.

Topic 1: Principles of pharmacology (10 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Define drug, receptor and dose.

Topic 2: Pharmacokinetics (25 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Explain absorption, distribution, metabolism and excretion.

Topic 3: Pharmacodynamics (25 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Describe drug-receptor interactions; Explain dose-response curves.

CP 211 Dispensing Practice

Year 2, Semester 1. Contact hours: 40.
Course description: This unit introduces learners to dispensing practice.

Topic 1: The prescription (10 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Interpret a prescription; Identify prescription errors.

Topic 2: Labelling and counselling (30 hours)
Learning objectives: by the end of this topic the learner should be able to: Label dispensed medicines; Counsel patients on use.